

Moonveil

Version 1.1

foodpuzz & lunarsignals

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What You Need

- 2–6 players
- A ton of six-sided dice (d6s)
- Pencil, paper, and character sheets

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Who is this for?

Something about the core design.

- Basic OSR structure
- Pocket Push Rolls

Create Your Seeker

You are a Seeker exploring the Moonveil looking for fallen Pieces of the Moon.

Level Ability and Hit Points

Write the numbers [2, 2, 1, 1] on your four **Ability Points** or roll d6.

d6	Strength	Dexterity	Insight	Willpower
1	2	2	1	1
2	2	1	2	1
3	2	1	1	2
4	1	2	2	1
5	1	2	1	2
6	1	1	2	2

Then determine your **Hit Points**. Set HP to $1d6 + 3 \times \text{Strength}$.

Equipment and Magic

Start with d6 **Coin** and 3 **Dungeon Gear** and then choose or roll for two starting gifts. If rolling, roll one d6 for type and another d6 for the specific one.

d6	d6	Gifts
1-2	1	Edged, like a sword. Hits do minimum 3 damage
	2	Piercing, like a spear. On a Strong Hit +2 damage
	3	Heavy, like a hammer or axe. On a Critical Hit +d6*
	4	Ranged 2. Accurate
	5	Tricky, like a chain or whip. On Strong Hit target Pocket Down
	6	A Bomb! 6d6 area damage
3-4	1-2	Helmet. Limit +1
	3-4	Shield. If Pocket ≥ 4 then your Evade +1
	5	Leather Armor. Damage Reduction -1, breaks on a Critical Hit
	6	Cloak. Can Pocket Roll on Move, breaks on a Critical Hit
5	1-2	Thickair , Heavylite , Moonsmell DC8 Insight. Solutions
	3-4	Egress , Invisibility DC9 Insight. Heist tools
	5	Magic Orb DC10 Insight. 2d6 area damage
	6	Sleepsand DC12 Insight. Sleep
6	1-3	Healing Circle DC10 Willpower. Heal +d6 to area
	4-6	Dawn Arm DC11 Willpower. Weapon +d6 damage until a miss

Pocket, Defense, and Finishing It Up

Evade and under rolls against you are misses. **Limit** and over rolls are Critical Hits. Set Evade to 5 and Limit to 10, adjusting for any equipment. Mark these with vertical lines to the right of Evade and to the left of Limit.

Pocket is your luck and momentum. Roll d6 and place that die face-up on your **Hit Track** on top of your **Defense**. Defense is equal to **Evade plus Pocket** and can never be bigger than Limit.

Finally then set your **Level** to 1 and fill in your **Name** and **Portrait**.

Rolling and the Pocket Push

Moonveil runs on the Pocket Push. Your **Pocket** lets you swap luck between rolls, while your **Ability Points** can be spent to press harder when the dice don't fall your way. Every choice carries forward—each roll shifts your odds for the next.

The Core Resolution

When you take a significant action, roll 2d6 and compare to the **Dice Check (DC)**. At or over the DC is a success. If the result of the roll is unfavorable you can choose to do one or both of the following.

1. **Pocket**: Replace one of the dice with your Pocket
2. **Push**: Mark a pip in a relevant Ability to reroll

Abilities and Pips

The Guide indicates which Abilities to use for a roll.

- **Strength**: fighting and raw power
- **Dexterity**: speed and precision
- **Insight**: depth of knowledge
- **Willpower**: inner drive

You can mark a number of pips in an Ability up to its value.

Advantage and Disadvantage

In a strong or weak position, roll an extra die.

- **Advantage**: remove the smaller die result.
- **Disadvantage**: remove the bigger die result.

Pocket Rolls

Some effects force a change to Pocket.

- **Pocket Roll**: set your Pocket to d6.
- **Pocket Up**: roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the bigger value.
- **Pocket Down**: roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the smaller value.

Exploding Roll

Roll d6. If the outcome is 6, roll another Exploding Roll. Add all dice rolled this way.

Items

Exploring the Moonveil means hauling gear — and sometimes hauling friends. Track everything you carry in **Equipment & Backpack**.

- **Slots:** Most items take up 1 slot. Larger items take up 2 or more slots.
- **Extra:** The smallest things like letters, keys, or coins are free to carry.

Dungeon Gear

Dungeon Gear is a special item that takes 1 slot. When you need it, it becomes any reasonable adventuring tool: e.g. a club, a knife, arrows, rope, a tent, a torch, rations. For some kinds of items roll d6 to determine how much is available. For example, if you pull out rope you have d6 x 10 feet of rope; if you pull rations you have enough food and drink for d6 Seekers.

If you think you might need something, ask the Guide if they would allow it as Dungeon Gear. If they say no, ask if you can buy it and how much.

Carrying Your Friends

Carrying a Seeker, without their gear, takes 5 slots. You need to accommodate slots for your own gear and any gear of theirs as well.

Capacity

Your carrying capacity is **6 plus Willpower**. When carrying more you are **Encumbered** and roll everything at Disadvantage. You cannot carry more than 12 total slots.

Magic

Magic comes in two forms: Spells and Miracles. Spells are shaped by Insight into the unknown. Miracles are drawn forth by sheer Willpower.

Casting Magic

When you cast a Spell or Miracle, roll 2d6 against its DC:

- Success: Roll $\geq$ DC – the effect takes place.
- Failure: Roll $<$ DC – the effect fizzles, and you lose it until you Rest.

Penance

Instead of spending Willpower to reroll a Miracle, you may take on Guilt.

- If you have no Guilt, fill 1 Backpack slot with Guilt.
- Otherwise, double the amount you are carrying.

Guilt cannot be discarded. Guilt is removed only by true atonement, as decided with the Guide.

Rest, Growth, and Death

Rest

In a safe space outside of an encounter, eat a meal and spend 8 hours recovering to recover.

- Erase all marked pips, recover lost Spells and Miracles
- Roll a number of d6 equal to your Level, add 3xStrength, and set your Max HP to this total if you choose.
- Heal all HP

Growth

When you reach a milestone, Level Up, gain +1 in an Ability Point, and increase HP accordingly.

Death

At 0 HP you are dying. Only safety and long, sustained care can save you. Otherwise, you are dead. Roll a new Seeker.

Encounters

In a clash of steel or a sprung trap - each moment is a test. Dice roll, Pockets swing, and Ability Points are spent. When you are in a good position, be aggressive! When you're not, think quick! Spend resources or take a big risk - or risk losing your head.

Initiative

Encounters are run in rounds. Start each round with a d6 **Initiative** roll to determine when you can act. On a 4–6 you act before the Guide; on a 1–3 you act after the Guide. Reroll by marking Dexterity.

- **Opening Seekers:** if you rolled 4-6 take you can take your turn first
- **Guide:**
 - Enemies act
 - Hazards trigger
 - World events advance
- **Closing Seekers:** if you have yet to take your turn, take it here

On your turn, take a Move and an Action in any order alongside other Seekers taking their turns.

Movement

Distances are measured by the number of Moves needed to cross them. 0 Moves means something is nearby and can be acted on immediately. 1 Move crosses a Distance of 2, 2 Moves crosses a Distance of 2, and so on.

Direction matters in a Melee as well. You protect whatever is behind you, and you can Move away in that direction as well. It costs 1 Move to reposition yourself in the same area. If you find yourself a junction, you will have to choose which side you defend.

- Spend a Move to cross a Distance of 1.
- Spend a Move to reposition yourself in the Melee.
- Spend a Move to gain better footing. Pocket Roll. Mark Dexterity to reroll.
- Spend an Action to gain another Move.

Obstacles

If you're in a melee and want to move behind an enemy, roll DC10 Dexterity check to Pass:

- Roll with Advantage if the enemy is engaged with someone or something else.
- Roll with Disadvantage if multiple enemies block the way or the space is too narrow.
- On failure the blocking enemy gets a free attack.

- Or if the space is at least 1 Move wide, spend a second Move to reposition yourself behind the enemy. Then move again

If you need to navigate carefully—such as crawling over allies in a cramped space, avoiding a trap, or crossing a slick surface—roll **Pocket Down**.

Actions

When you take an action, choose from one of the following or anything else you could reasonably attempt in a moment.

1. Attack

Make an attack to damage an enemy. First confirm the target:

- **Melee:** a nearby enemy, 0 Moves away. The opposing side chooses which enemy
- **Ranged:** an enemy of your choice up to the weapon's Range away.

Then roll 2d6 and compare both dice against the target's **Evade**, **Defense**, and **Limit** to determine if and how hard the attack hits.

Thresholds	Tier	Damage
≤ Evade	Miss	0
< Defense	Weak Hit	1
≥ Defense	Strong Hit	Bigger Die Value
≥ Limit	Critical Hit	Bigger Die Value

Weapons and abilities may add extra effects when you score a hit. These can trigger on any tier, but most often on Critical Hits.

2. Stunt Attack

Make a melee attack against a nearby enemy of your choice. Roll 2d6 against the enemy's **Defense** and **Limit**.

Thresholds	Effect
< Defense	None
≥ Defense	One Effect
≥ Limit	Two Effects

Choose from the follow effects:

- The enemy rolls Pocket Down
- Recover your Move OR force the enemy to Move 1
- Deal damage equal to your Smaller Die Value

3. Deduction

Spend an Action, mark 1 Insight, and work with the Guide to reveal insight into the challenge at hand.

- Identify an Advantage over a challenge or enemy or remove a Disadvantage affecting the team.
- Reveal a new possibility like an enemy behavior that could be helpful.

Refund if the result is not useful.

4. Rally

Spend an Action and mark 1 Willpower to

- Erase marked pips in Strength, Dexterity, and Insight
- Restore 1d6 Hit Points

Gambits

Wager your Ability Points to perform Gambits.

Power

Before a melee attack if you have at least 1 pip of Strength.

- On a Strong Hit or better, apply d6 bonus damage to
 - the original target or...
 - to each nearby enemy
- If your attack roll is less than 10, mark all your Strength.

Finesse

Before a melee attack if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Choose a target among nearby enemies.
- Before your attack the target rolls Pocket Down.
- On a Strong Hit or better,
 - recover your Move or...
 - force the enemy to Move 1
- If your attack roll is less than 10, mark all your Dexterity.

Precision

Before a ranged attack if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Deal double damage
- If your attack roll is less than 10, mark all your Dexterity

Full Defend

After being hit if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Roll DC10 Dexterity. On success, negate all damage and effects.
- On failure, take full damage, and mark all your Dexterity.